

Lesson 12

Managing Task Updates



Warm-Up

Think about your current or previous work experience.

1. How do you usually update your manager or team about your tasks?
2. What details do you include?



Role-Play

***Scenario:** Sophia, a project manager, asks Tom, a software developer, for an update on his current task.*

Sophia: Hi David, can you give me a quick update on the bug fix for the payment system?

Tom: Sure! I've identified the issue—it was caused by a recent API change. I've already fixed the main problem and tested it in the staging environment.

Sophia: That's great. When do you think it will be ready for deployment?

Tom: I just need to run one more round of testing. If everything looks good, I can deploy it by tomorrow afternoon.

Sophia: Sounds good! Keep me posted if anything changes.

Tom: Will do!

Role-play Analysis

1. What task is David working on?
2. What was the cause of the issue?
3. What steps has David completed so far?
4. When does David expect to complete the task?
5. What does Emma ask David to do if there are any changes?

Discussion

- How can clear and concise task updates improve teamwork and project efficiency?



Practice

A. Fill-in the blanks.

Instructions: Read the conversation below and fill in the blanks with appropriate words. Then, practice speaking the dialogue with a partner.

Manager: Hi _____ (**partner's name**), can you give me a quick update on your current task?

Employee: Sure! I am working on _____ (**task name**), and I have already _____ (**completed step**).

Manager: That's good to hear. Have you faced any challenges?

Employee: Yes, I had an issue with _____ (**problem**), but I _____ (**solution taken**).

Manager: Great! When do you expect to finish?

Employee: If everything goes well, I should be done by _____ (**timeframe**).

Manager: Sounds good! Keep me _____ if anything changes.

Employee: Will do!

B. Reporting Task Progress

Instructions: Read each question, choose the best answer, and explain your choice in a full sentence. Then, practice saying it out loud.

1. What is the best way to start a task update?

- a) I don't know what's happening.
- b) I have some updates on my task.
- c) Why do you need an update?

The best way to start a task update is _____.

2. How should you describe progress on a task?

- a) I finished everything, but I forgot the details.
- b) I have completed the first two steps and will start testing tomorrow.
- c) It's complicated, so I won't explain.

To describe progress, I should say _____.

3. If there is a delay, how should you explain it?

- a) There is a small delay because we found a bug, but we are fixing it now.
- b) I don't know when it will be done.
- c) It's late, but I don't want to talk about it.

If there is a delay, I should say _____.

4. How can you politely ask for more time to complete a task?

- a) I need more time. Just wait.
- b) I underestimated the time needed, but I should be done by tomorrow.
- c) I won't be able to finish, and I don't know when it will be ready.

To ask for more time politely, I should say _____.

5. How should you respond if a manager asks you for an update, but you haven't made much progress?

- a) I haven't done anything yet. I'll let you know later.
- b) I started working on it, but I faced some issues. I am looking for a solution now.
- c) I don't want to talk about it right now.

If I haven't made much progress, I should say _____.



Production

Task Update Simulation

Instructions: Work in pairs. One person acts as a *team leader*, and the other acts as a *team member* giving a task update. Use the prompts below to guide your conversation. Then, switch roles and practice again.

Scenario: Your team is working on a project with a deadline approaching. The team leader asks for an update on a specific task. The team member must respond using clear and professional language.

1. The Team Leader Asks for an Update

2. The Team Member Gives a Task Update

Discussion

- What are the key elements of an effective task update, and why are they important for teamwork and project success?



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Use	Example
I'd like to give you a quick update on (task name).	To introduce your update clearly and professionally.	<i>I'd like to give you a quick update on the software bug fix. So far, I have identified the issue and tested a solution</i>
I have finished (task/stage)	To explain what has been done so far.	<i>I have finished the initial testing, and the task is 80% complete. I expect to finish by Friday.</i>
There was a delay due to (reason), but I'm working on it now.	To explain difficulties and how you are handling them.	<i>There was a delay due to an API error, but I'm working on a fix now.</i>
Estimate	A rough time or number for completion	<i>I estimate that the task will take two more days.</i>
Ahead of schedule	The task will be completed earlier than expected.	<i>We are ahead of schedule and should finish by tomorrow.</i>



Wrap-up

“The art of communication is the language of leadership.” — James Humes

Do you agree? If yes, Why? If not, explain.